

New Construction Coverage Checklist

Before and after closing on a new build. After the 2021 Marshall Fire, a CU Boulder–led study found 74% of affected policyholders were underinsured. The fix is cheapest in month one.

Before closing

1. **Rebuild cost, not purchase price.** Ask how your dwelling limit was calculated. Purchase price includes land, market, and builder margin. Rebuild cost is materials and labor today.
2. **Extended replacement cost.** Ask for an endorsement that pays above your limit if rebuilding costs run over.
3. **Start date.** Your homeowners policy must be in force on closing day. The builder's coverage during construction doesn't carry over to you.
4. **Warranty is not insurance.** The builder's warranty covers workmanship defects. Insurance covers sudden losses like hail, fire, and theft. You need both.
5. **Wind/hail deductible.** Flat dollar amount or a percentage? Know the number.
6. **Water backup.** Usually excluded unless you add it. It matters with a finished basement.

First 30 days after move-in

1. **Add what you add.** Finishing the basement, a fence, a deck, landscaping, sprinklers, or solar can raise rebuild cost. Update your coverage when you add them.
2. **Home inventory.** Walk every room, closet, and the garage with your phone camera. Save it to the cloud.
3. **Garaging address.** Update your auto policy to the new address.

Three questions about the mortgage

1. If your income stopped tomorrow, how many months could your family make the mortgage payment?
2. Does your life insurance, including anything through work, cover the mortgage balance?
3. Would that coverage continue if you changed jobs?

Send me your dec page and closing date, and I'll check it against this list in 10 minutes:

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